REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND FIVE YEAR PLANS

DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY → UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS → GROWTH POLE MECHANISM → CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH → PLANNING REGION CRITERIA → INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g6 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY

STAGE 00

DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY | DIFFERENCE OF CHARACTER | LANGUAGE, ECOLOGY, CULTURE, CROPS | RANKED INEQUALITY | INCOME, LITERACY, HEALTH, INFRASTRUCTURE | DIVERSITY IS ACCOMMODATED; DISPARITY IS REDUCED | TREATING INEQUALITY AS HARMLESS VARIETY IS A DIRECT EXAM MUST REMEMBER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops	POLICY → diversity is accommodated; disparity is reduced	MUST REMEMBER: Regional development links spatial inequality, cumulative causation, growth poles, spread and backwash, core-periphery, agropolitan
DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure	TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error	and balanced/unbalanced strategies to India's planning regions, river-valley projects, industrial location, infrastructure corridors and district-level intervention.

CORE CLAIM

- DIVERSITY → difference of character: language, ecology, culture, crops
- DISPARITY → ranked inequality: income, literacy, health, infrastructure

MECHANISM

- POLICY → diversity is accommodated; disparity is reduced
- TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Regional development links spatial inequality, cumulative causation, growth poles, spread and backwash, core-periphery, agropolitan
- and balanced/unbalanced strategies to India's planning regions, river-valley projects, industrial location, infrastructure corridors and district-level intervention.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → treating inequality as harmless variety is a direct exam error.

01 UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS

STAGE 01

UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS | RESOURCE ENDOWMENT | MINERALS, FERTILE LAND, PORTS OR IRRIGATION CLUSTER GROWTH | TRANSPORT + MARKET | CORRIDORS AND URBAN NODES OUTPACE INTERIORS | HISTORICAL HEAD START | EARLIER CENTRES KEEP CUMULATIVE ADVANTAGE | STATE CAPACITY

RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth → TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors → HISTORICAL HEAD START → earlier centres keep cumulative advantage → STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up

CORE CLAIM

- RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth
- TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors

MECHANISM

- HISTORICAL HEAD START → earlier centres keep cumulative advantage
- STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RESOURCE ENDOWMENT → minerals, fertile land, ports or irrigation cluster growth
- TRANSPORT + MARKET → corridors and urban nodes outpace interiors

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATE CAPACITY → policy and governance decide whether lagging regions catch up.

02 GROWTH POLE MECHANISM

STAGE 02

GROWTH POLE MECHANISM | PROPULSIVE NODE | DYNAMIC INDUSTRY OR CITY BECOMES THE GROWTH POLE | SUPPLIERS, LABOUR AND MARKETS CLUSTER AROUND THE POLE | SPREAD EFFECT | BENEFITS DIFFUSE OUTWARD IF LINKAGES DEEPEN LOCALLY | A POLE MAY REMAIN AN ENCLAVE WITHOUT REGIONAL DIFFUSION

PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole → LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole → SPREAD EFFECT → benefits diffuse outward if linkages deepen locally → LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

CORE CLAIM

- PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole
- LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

MECHANISM

- SPREAD EFFECT → benefits diffuse outward if linkages deepen locally
- LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PROPULSIVE NODE → dynamic industry or city becomes the growth pole
- LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion.

03 CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH

STAGE 03

CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH | CAPITAL, SERVICES, INFRASTRUCTURE AND DECISION POWER CONCENTRATE | LABOUR, RAW MATERIALS AND DEMAND ARE ORGANISED AROUND THE | TALENT AND CAPITAL DRAIN OUTWARD TOWARD THE CORE | TECHNOLOGY AND DEMAND MAY DIFFUSE, BUT NOT AUTOMATICALLY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate	BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core	CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core	SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically	PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

CORE CLAIM

- CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
- PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

MECHANISM

- BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core
- SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
- PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically.

04 PLANNING REGION CRITERIA

STAGE 04

PLANNING REGION CRITERIA | FUNCTIONAL UNITY | FLOWS AND LINKAGES HOLD THE REGION TOGETHER | ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY | POLICY MUST ACTUALLY BE IMPLEMENTABLE | ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY | STRATEGY AND RESOURCE BASE MUST ALIGN | SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together	ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align	FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable	SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success	ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

CORE CLAIM

- FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
- ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

MECHANISM

- ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align
- SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
- ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success.

05 INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

STAGE 05

INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE | NATIONAL PLANNING COMMITTEE BEGINS THE PLANNING IMAGINATION | PLANNING COMMISSION SET UP AND FIRST PLAN LAUNCHED | ANNUAL PLANS AFTER WAR, DROUGHT AND MACRO STRESS | TWELFTH PLAN LAST CYCLE; NITI REPLACES PLANNING COMMISSION

1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination → 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched → 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress → 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commision

CORE CLAIM

- 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination
- 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

MECHANISM

- 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress
- 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination
- 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission.

06 FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN

STAGE 06

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN | FIRST PLAN | IRRIGATION, AGRICULTURE, REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT, POWER | SECOND PLAN | HEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC-SECTOR INDUSTRIAL BASE | SPATIAL LOGIC | AGRARIAN RECOVERY FIRST, INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION NEXT | DO NOT SWAP THE PRIORITIES OF THE TWO PLANS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power	SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next	FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base	TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans	SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

CORE CLAIM

- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

MECHANISM

- SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next
- TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans.

07 WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED

STAGE 07

WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED | UNEVEN IRRIGATION | GREEN REVOLUTION GAINS STAYED REGIONALLY SELECTIVE | INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION | PORTS, METROS AND CORRIDORS PULLED AHEAD | CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS | INTERIORS REMAINED INFRASTRUCTURE-POOR | BALANCED REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT STAYED INCOMPLETE

UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective → INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead → CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor → OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

CORE CLAIM

- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

MECHANISM

- CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor
- OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor.

08 PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI

STAGE 08

PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI | PLANNING COMMISSION | CENTRALISED PLAN FORMULATION AND OUTLAY LOGIC | NITI AAYOG | THINK-TANK COORDINATION, COMPETITIVE AND COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM | PLAN DOCUMENTS | LONG-HORIZON ALLOCATION FRAMEWORK | INDICATOR MONITORING AND MISSION-MODE COMPARISON

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic	PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework	PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism	DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison	NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

CORE CLAIM

- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

MECHANISM

- PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework
- DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism.

09 DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER

STAGE 09

DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER | STATE AVERAGE | USEFUL, BUT HIDES INTERNAL INEQUALITY | DISTRICT TARGETING | ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS BRINGS LAGGING DISTRICTS INTO FOCUS | BLOCK TARGETING | SCALE MOVES FURTHER DOWNWARD WHERE DISTRICT AVERAGES STILL HIDE | GEOGRAPHIC LESSON

STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality

DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus → BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps → GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

CORE CLAIM

- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus
- BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps

MECHANISM

- GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Five Year Plans ended after the Twelfth Plan period and the Planning
- Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Commision was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015; plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

10 SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING

STAGE 10

SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING | SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 | OVERALL INDIA SCORE 71 | TERRITORIAL INDICATORS | DEVELOPMENT IS RANKED SPATIALLY, NOT ONLY NATIONALLY | CURRENT STYLE | DASHBOARDS COMPLEMENT MISSIONS AND PROGRAMME CONVERGENCE | SAFE USE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71	SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity	convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.
TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Damodar Valley, NCR, Dandakaranya, command areas, hill/tribal regions.	
CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence	Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity	

CORE CLAIM

- SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71
- TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally
- CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence

MECHANISM

- SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Damodar Valley, NCR, Dandakaranya, command areas, hill/tribal regions.
- Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity; convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.

11 REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE

STAGE 11

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE | DISPARITY VERSUS DIVERSITY AND THE MEANING OF REGIONAL PLANNING | GROWTH POLE, CORE-PERIPHERY, SPREAD AND BACKWASH | 1938 COMMITTEE, FIRST PLAN, SECOND PLAN, NITI TRANSITION | DISTRICT DASHBOARDS MATTER BECAUSE STATE AVERAGES CONCEAL DISPARITY

DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning → EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash → TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition → QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

CORE CLAIM

- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

MECHANISM

- TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition
- QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | ONE INTERPRETATION SAYS INDIA HAS MOVED FROM CENTRALISED FIVE-YEAR | ANOTHER SAYS THE UNDERLYING ISSUE REMAINS THE SAME | HOW TO REDUCE | REGIONAL IMBALANCE IN LAGGING DISTRICTS, SMALL TOWNS, TRIBAL BELTS | A GOOD MAINS ANSWER SHOULD THEREFORE TREAT NITI AS | THE PLANNING COMMISSION WAS REPLACED BY NITI AAYOG ON | THE TWELFTH PLAN WAS THE LAST FIVE-YEAR PLAN CYCLE.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: One interpretation says India has moved from centralised Five-Year Plans to more flexible mission-based and state-compared governance.
- CAUTION: Another says the underlying issue remains the same: how to reduce
- regional imbalance in lagging districts, small towns, tribal belts and infrastructure-poor interiors.
- CAUTION: A good Mains answer should therefore treat NITI as a change in planning style, not the end of planning geography.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.
- The Twelfth Plan was the last Five-Year Plan cycle.
- Balanced regional development remained an explicit concern but an incomplete achievement.
- Aspirational Districts Programme targets districts, not states as a whole.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- SDG India Index is a territorial-development benchmarking tool.
- NOT: NITI Aayog is simply the Planning Commission with a new name - The institutional style and policy mechanism changed significantly.
- NOT: Ending Five-Year Plans ended planning - Planning continues through missions, indices, state coordination and targeted programmes.
- NOT: Regional imbalance is only about poor states - It also exists within states, between districts and between metros and hinterlands.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels